

SNIPPETS

Consumer durable companies going for price cuts!

LG colour televisions will now be cheaper by 2.5 per cent, washing machine prices will be cut by 2 per cent and refrigerators will cost 1.5 per lower from their current price. Samsung and Godrej also plan to provide some relaxation to buyers. Other companies like Whirlpool and Videocon are still adopting a wait-and-watch approach.

Sony to hold prices for now

Sony is not going for price cuts now and is reconsidering over the policies. Regardless of the decline in the excise duty, the company has decided to hold the prices because of the unfavourable exchange rate fluctuations. On the other hand, Samsung and LG have decided to slightly cut prices of plasma and LCD TVs, refrigerators and washing machines.

IT industry's growth hard to predict

National Association of Software Suppliers and Companies (NASSCOM) is finding it difficult to estimate the growth trends in the IT sector. It said the industry would grow slower in the year to March than the 24 per cent growth it registered in the six months to September, but did not provide a new estimate. India's software firms will continue to face an uncertain business environment over the next 18 months.

Broadcom to power Airtel DTH TV

Bharti Airtel has selected Broadcom's highly integrated satellite set-top box (STB) system-on-a-chip (SoC) solutions to power its direct-to-home (DTH) TV services—Airtel digital TV—marking Broadcom's first commercial satellite product launch in India. Broadcom Corporation is a global leader in semiconductors for wired and wireless communications.

Videocon puts DTH rollout on hold

The economic slowdown has led consumer durables manufacturer Videocon to delay the launch of its direct-to-home (DTH) TV venture, D2H. The service, which was scheduled for August launch, has now been postponed to the next fiscal, when it will also launch its cellular service Datacom.

Telesoft sets up telecom lab in India

UK-based Telesoft Technologies, a provider of reliable and cost-effective telecom, monitoring, homeland security and intelligence solutions, has set up its telecom laboratory in India to assist integration and rollout of new partner products in the region. The lab has Telesoft's complete range of products allowing local customers to quickly integrate and test software applications and ensure network compatibility in real world conditions.

Sony cuts 8000 jobs!

As the economy sinks, Sony is planning to reduce headcount in the electronics business worldwide by approximately 8000, out of 160,000 as of Sept. 30, 2008. The intended reduction is part of the company's cost-cutting plan that aims to save more than 100 billion yen (\$1.1 billion) by the end of March 31, 2010.

TCS to employ over 3500 in China

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) is planning to employ more than 3500 people in China over the next four years. Girija Pande, head, TCS, Asia Pacific operations, has said that at present, there are 1300 employees in China working in four centres and they plan to have 5000 people in the next four years.

from India and six out of the eight entries are from Hewlett Packard (HP). Among vendors, HP leads the list with a 41.8 per cent share of the systems, followed by IBM (37 per cent), Dell (4 per cent) and Cray (4 per cent).

Supercomputer Eka, an HP-based system with a performance of 132.8 teraflops, has been ranked 13th. It belongs to the Tata Group's Computational Research Laboratories. The other supercomputers by HP from India are for C-DAC, an industrial research company, a research company, IIT-Madras and Paprikaas Interactive Services.

The two other supercomputers from India out of the eight include IBM's eServer Blue Gene Solution for Indian Institute of Science and a supercomputer for Digital Media Company.

After netbooks, here come nettops

Netbooks, the smaller version of laptops, were launched in June 2008. Now, on the similar lines, PC makers like ASUS, HCL Infosystems and Wipro are ready to push the retail sales of smaller desktops or nettops, based on Intel atom processors. Others like Dell, HP and Lenovo are expected to follow the suit.

The system (excluding the monitor) will cost around Rs 6000 to assemble. However, the retail price ranges between Rs 11,000 and Rs 18,000 since the manufacturers include a bulky CRT or thin LCD monitor and optional CD/DVD drives.

Aimed primarily at e-mail and Internet users, nettops and netbooks provide a low-cost option for education, photo and video viewing, social networking, voice over IP, e-mail, messaging, browsing and other basic activities as well as for basic applications.

"They are not suitable for high-end gaming but anyway, that's not the purpose," said Intel India managing director (sales and marketing), South Asia, Ramamurthy Sivakumar.